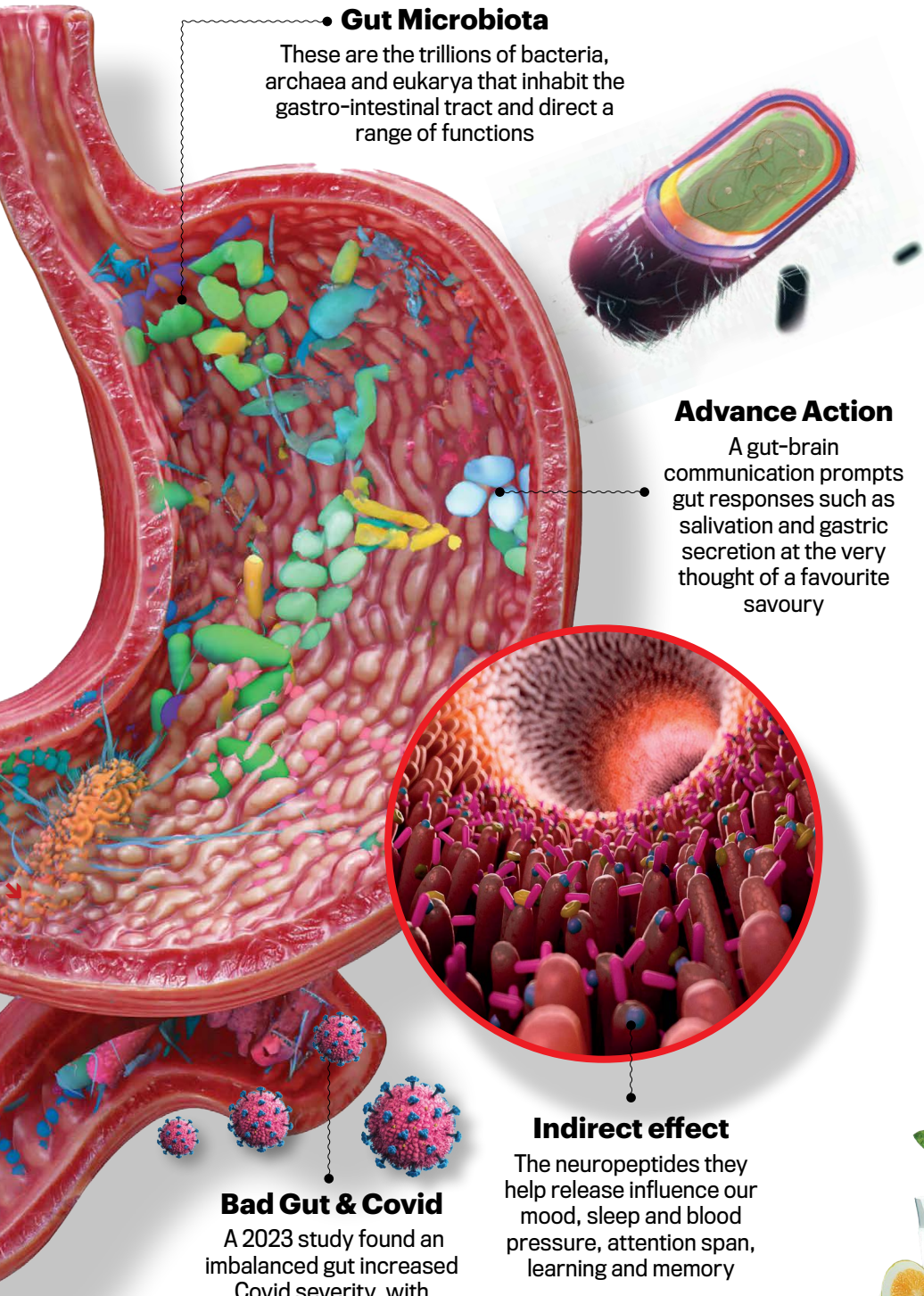


Gut Microbiota

These are the trillions of bacteria, archaea and eukarya that inhabit the gastro-intestinal tract and direct a range of functions

Advance Action

A gut-brain communication prompts gut responses such as salivation and gastric secretion at the very thought of a favourite savoury

Indirect effect

The neuropeptides they help release influence our mood, sleep and blood pressure, attention span, learning and memory

Bad Gut & Covid

A 2023 study found an imbalanced gut increased Covid severity, with microbiota influencing release of cytokines

TRENDING TREATMENTS

- **Korean microbiome walking:** Increasing the amount you walk in a day can help you get a healthy gut like the Koreans
- **Synbiotic treatments:** Actor Hrithik Roshan recently partnered with The Good Bug to launch a new range of probiotic strains that can alter your gut flora to improve your metabolism
- **Gut gummies:** Pro and prebiotic health supplements
- **Gluten-free diets:** Many have switched to wheat-free breads, pizzas and cakes
- **Plant-based diets:** They provide more fibre, and are a healthy alternative to antibiotic-fed poultry
- **Kefirs, Kombuchas and Kimchi:** While fermented foods of all kinds are good for the gut, these three products have become a popular choice
- **Digestive enzymes:** Proteins that mimic enzymes in our body and help break down food
- **Detox waters:** Activated charcoal waters, turmeric waters or apple cider waters, all cut out toxins in the body
- **Gut cleanses:** Simple, easy to digest package of mostly liquids or semi-solids



UNIQUE INDIAN GUT IN DANGER

- Nearly 1 million microbial genes are unique to Indian intestines
- Gut microbes in rural India have been found to be healthier, more diverse than urban areas
- Indians have higher average stool weight (311g) a day than those in the West (200g) and higher average stool frequency (once a day), considered to be very healthy
- The 2023 'Gut Health Survey' found 7 out of 10 urban Indians to have poor gut health
- While Indians have had low prevalence of major gut issues like Irritable Bowel Syndrome and colon cancer, figures are rising due to changing diets. IBS rose 3% (2011-2017) and colon cancer by 20% (2004 to 2014)